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What is SLI?

Scalable Link Interface is a method of parallel processing for computer graphics, in which two or more video cards can be linked to produce a single, more enhanced output.

Where was SLI technology first deployed on a commercial scale?

An initial version (dubbed 'Scan Line Interleave') was used by the US-based 3dfx in 1998, in the Voodoo 2 line of graphics accelerators.

When was the modern SLI introduced?

nVidia and ATI developed their own versions, that were rechristened 'Scalable Link Interface' in 2004.

How do the SLI versions differ?

In 3dfx's SLI, the two connected cards compose a frame by rendering alternating horizontal lines of pixels. While the nVidia SLI splits the screen into two parts, one GPU rendering each, ATI's solution breaks the screen into little squares.

Why does SLI have an edge over ordinary graphics cards?

By harnessing the processing power of two graphics cards, SLI-enabled systems can roughly—although not completely—double the performance of a single Graphics Processing Unit (GPU) configuration.

Who is the target audience?

With better image compositing and rendering, SLI-enabled systems are a must for the die-hard gamer. There's a caveat: deep pockets required, as SLI systems need to be complemented with a high-end motherboard and processor, as well as a top-notch display unit.

usage of resources like soil and water. ISRO has also placed remote sensing satellites in orbit to transmit information to the centres.

LONG-AWAITED

OS X Tiger Launched

Tiger, the fifth major version of Mac OS X, has more than 200 new features and innovations, including Spotlight, a desktop search engine, which will completely integrate into the operating system.

Other features include a 'Dashboard' to access 'Widgets' that let users get information quickly and return to work ASAP. 'iChat' enables audio and video conferences with up to 10 people. 'Automator' helps automate complex or repetitive tasks without programming, and Safari RSS enables RSS feeds to cull information from news organisations, community Web sites and blogs.

LOTS OF APPLICATIONS

Abundant Adobe

Adobe launched its Creative Suite 2 (CS2) worldwide on April 4, 2005. The CS2 is being pegged as a tool to help print and Web workflows for creative professionals. It includes Adobe Photoshop CS2, Adobe InDesign, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe GoLive and Version Cue. Also included is Adobe Acrobat 7.0.

The CS2 has a new component—Adobe Bridge that acts as a hub for productivity, imagery, and creativity. It provides multi-view file browsing and smooth cross-product integration across the CS2 software.

The designers can preview multi-page PDF files, drag and drop from floating Compact Mode

windows, process images with built-in Camera Raw 3.0, edit and search for Adobe XMP metadata.

To simplify the purchase and management of stock imagery, Adobe CS2 introduces Adobe Stock Photos. It brings together more than 230,000 images from some of the world's leading stock photography providers including Photodisc by Getty Images, Comstock Images by Jupitermedia, Digital Vision, Imageshop royalty free by Zefaimages. Version Cue in CS2 is a file-version manager and collaboration tool that helps users visually preview, track and access historical and alternate versions of files in CS2 projects.

Adobe GoLive is a powerful authoring tool for Web and mobile content. GoLive CS2 introduces new CSS layout tools which can be used by Web designers and developers to create, publish, manage and update content that adapts easily to the latest generation of handhelds. Adobe GoLive CS2 delivers mobile authoring tools based on open standards to support mobile layout (CSS, XHTML), multimedia and interactivity (SVG, SVG-t) and video (3GPP, MPEG-4) for mobile devices. The estimated street price for Adobe CS2 Premium Edition in India is Rs 65,300 and Rs 48,900 for the CS2 Standard Edition.

LAX LOCAL TV NETWORKS

BitTorrent To The Rescue!

Australians are catching new episodes of their favourite American television shows from

P2P applications such as BitTorrent.

According to an independent study conducted by a former general counsel for the Australian Recording Industry Association, the popularity of BitTorrent in Australia



is driven in part by local TV networks which are slow to air recent episodes of popular TV shows.

SEEKING TO MATURE

Disney Invades Gamezone

Disney's Buena Vista Games has purchased Salt Lake City-based Avalanche Software for an undisclosed amount. Buena Vista Games is also setting up a development studio in Vancouver that will create action-adventure games.

By buying Avalanche, Disney is seeking to mature into an established game development house. Avalanche developed *Tak and the Power of Juju*, published by THQ, and *Dragon Ball Z: Sagas* for Atari. According to Disney, they will focus on creating 'family-friendly' games. A team of developers formerly at EA will be heading Disney's Vancouver-based studio. ■

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